

SPECIAL NOTE: Attempt any 68 Marks out of 80 Marks (Total Questions: 11)**SECTION - A : READING COMPREHENSION****(20 Marks)**

1. Read the following passage. Make notes (5 marks), write a summary (4 marks) and supply a suitable title (1 mark):

[10 Marks]**Reading Passage 1: Health & Holistic Well-being**

Good health is the foundation of a happy life. It is often said that health is wealth because without good health, even the greatest riches cannot give true happiness. Health does not simply mean the absence of disease, but it also includes physical fitness, mental peace, and emotional balance. To maintain good health, one must follow healthy habits in everyday life.

A balanced diet plays the most important role in keeping the body fit. Food rich in proteins, vitamins, minerals, and carbohydrates provides the required energy for daily work. Junk food, oily snacks, and excess sugar harm the body and should be taken in limited amounts. Along with good food, regular exercise is also necessary. Simple activities like walking, jogging, yoga, or cycling keep the body active and prevent many lifestyle diseases.

Equally important is mental health. In today's world, stress and anxiety are common, and they affect overall well-being. Meditation, reading, listening to music, and spending time with family and friends help in maintaining inner peace. Good sleep is another essential factor for both physical and mental health. Thus, health is a combination of good food, proper exercise, sound sleep, and mental happiness. By taking small but consistent steps, everyone can achieve a healthy and fulfilling life.

2. Read the following passage and answer the questions given at the end:

[10 Marks]**Reading Passage 2: Electric Mobility & Sustainable Transportation**

The transportation industry is undergoing a major transformation with the rise of electric vehicles (EVs). Unlike traditional vehicles that rely on fossil fuels, EVs run on electricity, producing zero direct emissions. This shift is crucial for combating air pollution and reducing greenhouse gas emissions, which contribute to climate change.

Electric vehicles offer several advantages. They are quieter, require less maintenance, and are more energy-efficient compared to conventional vehicles. Governments around the world are promoting EV adoption through incentives, subsidies, and investment in charging infrastructure. Major automakers are also committing to manufacturing more electric models, signalling a long-term shift in the automotive industry.

However, challenges remain. The production of batteries requires significant resources and can have environmental impacts. Charging infrastructure is still limited in many areas, making long-distance travel difficult. Additionally, the initial cost of EVs is higher than traditional cars, though this is gradually decreasing as technology advances.

Despite these challenges, the transition to electric vehicles represents a vital step toward sustainable transportation. As technology improves and awareness grows, EVs are expected to become more accessible and widely adopted. By embracing electric mobility, societies can reduce pollution, conserve natural resources, and move toward a cleaner, greener future.

- (i). What are the key advantages of Electric Vehicles (EVs) mentioned in the passage?

[1 Mark]

- (ii). How are Governments around the world promoting EV adoption?

[1 Mark]

- (iii). What powers electric vehicles compared to traditional automobiles?

[1 Mark]

- (iv). A major challenge of EVs highlighted in the text is: (a) Lack of roads (b) Battery production impact (c) Excessive noise (d) Air pollution [1 Mark]
- (v). Use the word 'crucial' in a grammatically correct sentence of your own. [1 Mark]
- (vi). Fill in the blank: By embracing, societies can reduce pollution and conserve natural resources. [1 Mark]
- (vii). The word 'adoption' in the passage context most nearly means: [1 Mark]
- (viii). EVs run on electricity, producing zero direct emissions. (State True or False) [1 Mark]
- (ix). Write down the antonym of the word 'Conventional'. [1 Mark]
- (x). In the phrase 'combating air pollution', the word 'combating' functions as a: (a) Noun (b) Verb (c) Adjective (d) Adverb [1 Mark]

SECTION - B : WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR

(28 Marks)

3. Your institution has decided to organise an Eco-Friendly Day to create awareness about environmental sustainability. Draft an attractive poster giving all necessary details. (30-50 words) [4 Marks]

--- OR ---

You are a start-up entrepreneur and need a receptionist for your digital marketing business. Draft an advertisement for the classified column stating qualifications, experience, and salary. (30-50 words)

4. You have noticed many stray animals on the road during peak traffic hours causing severe jams and accidents. Write a letter to the Editor of a local daily drawing attention of the Municipal Chairman for immediate redressal. (120-150 words) [6 Marks]

--- OR ---

There is a dire need to impart moral education in schools. Write a letter to the Director of School Education requesting moral education as a compulsory subject and suggesting secular literature to promote brotherhood. (120-150 words)

5. Write an email to your close friend who has been recovering from illness, inquiring about his/her health and wishing a speedy recovery. (50-80 words) [4 Marks]
6. Failure and success are inseparable parts of life. Write an article titled 'Failure is a Stepping Stone to Success' as the Student Editor of your school magazine. (150-200 words) [6 Marks]

--- OR ---

To cultivate book reading habits, your school organized a gala 'Book Week'. As Head Boy / Head Girl, write an official report of the event for publication in a local newspaper. (150-200 words)

7. Read the following passage carefully and edit it by identifying and correcting the 8 numbered grammatical errors: 'The road to success is no a bed of roses (1). Only those who wade on hazards and hurdles can achieve successful (2), (3). Set yourself clear goals and define precisely what you wants to do (4). Goals provide direction for your behaviour and guide your actions and thoughts (5). Specific goals are better than general ones. Let every parts of your body is full of that idea (6), (7). Winners do not do different things, they does things differently (8).'
- [8 Marks]

SECTION - C : LITERATURE

(32 Marks)

- 8.(a). Read the following poetic stanza and answer the questions that [4 Marks]

follow: 'Eternal I rise impalpable out of the land and the bottomless sea, Upward to heaven, whence, vaguely form'd, altogether changed, and yet the same, I descend to lave the droughts, atomies, dust layers of the globe.'

- (i) What is the origin of 'rain' as described in the above lines?
- (ii) How is the cyclic movement of rain brought out by the poet?
- (iii) Name the poem and the poet who composed these lines.
- (iv) Identify and explain any two poetic devices used in the extract.

8.(b). Answer any TWO of the following questions in 40-50 words each:

[6 Marks]

- (i) What is the poignant meaning of the line 'Both wry with the laboured ease of loss'? (A Photograph)
- (ii) Why is the striking image of the engine evoked by the poet? (The Laburnum Top)
- (iii) What according to the poem is involved in the essential process of growing up? (Childhood)

9. Answer any THREE of the following questions in 40-50 words each:

[9 Marks]

- (i) Give three reasons why the author's grandmother was deeply disturbed when he attended city school. (The Portrait of a Lady)
- (ii) How does the narrative demonstrate that courage and optimism help endure 'The Direst Stress'? (We're Not Afraid to Die...)
- (iii) What does the notice 'The World's Most Dangerous Animal' at Lusaka Zoo signify? (The Ailing Planet)
- (iv) Explain the historical significance of the statement: 'King Tut is one of the first mummies to be scanned - in death, as in life'. (Discovering Tut)
- (v) Briefly elucidate: 'You neither travelled to the past nor the future. You were in the present experiencing a different world'. (The Adventure)

10. Did the boys return the stolen horse because they were conscience-stricken or because they were afraid? Justify with textual evidence from 'The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse'. (150-200 words)

[7 Marks]

--- OR ---

'I have done something; Oh God! I've done something real at last.' Why does Dr. Andrew Manson utter these emotional words? Explain the life-saving episode in 'Birth'.

11. 'Mother's Day' is a satirical and humorous portrayal of the often taken-for-granted status of a housewife in a family. Comment critically with reference to Mrs. Pearson. (120-150 words)

[6 Marks]

--- OR ---

Narrate the whimsical and humorous story of 'The Tale of Melon City' in your own words highlighting the theme of foolish governance.